

It's not banal poppycock to say today that we've got to succeed through the service we can render the investing public. And it's only looking facts in the face to say that a legitimate, honest service is the only justification for success.

We think the public is still ready and willing to invest in securities, through brokers and the exchanges. We have been having some surveys made which, along with the surveys made by the New York Stock Exchange, have turned up some disturbing—and encouraging—facts.

The customer may not always be right, but he has rights, and upon our recognition of his rights and our desire to satisfy them, rests our chance to succeed.

Disturbing is the large percentage of potential investors and speculators in securities who are suspicious of the motives and operations of the security business and the people engaged therein. You and we know the reasons for this lack of confidence and we know that it won't be eliminated until we convince the public that our house is now in order.

CONFIDENCE, IN THE MAIN, IS ON THE INCREASE

Encouraging is the even larger percentage of people who now generally express confidence in our business, but also have definite ideas about how we should continue to operate it to retain that confidence.

Our plan is based on our appraisal of what our firms ought to do to meet this situation. If we do the best we can, and if we have properly adjudged what the investing public wants, our plan will succeed.